Exp. No: 9

ANALYSIS OF PHOTODETECTOR NOISE AND SNR USING MATLAB

OBJECTIVES:

Analyze the key noise sources in an optical photodetector, namely shot noise, dark current noise and thermal (receiver) noise. 2. Compute the individual and total noise current variances (σ^2) across a range of input optical powers. 3. Evaluate the Signal-to-Noise Ratio (SNR) and observe its scaling in the thermalnoise-limited and shot-noise-limited regimes. 4. Calculate the Minimum Detectable Optical Power (Pmin) at SNR = 1 (0 dB). 5. Simulate and visualize photodetector noise and SNR curves using MATLAB.

SOFTWARE REQUIRED:

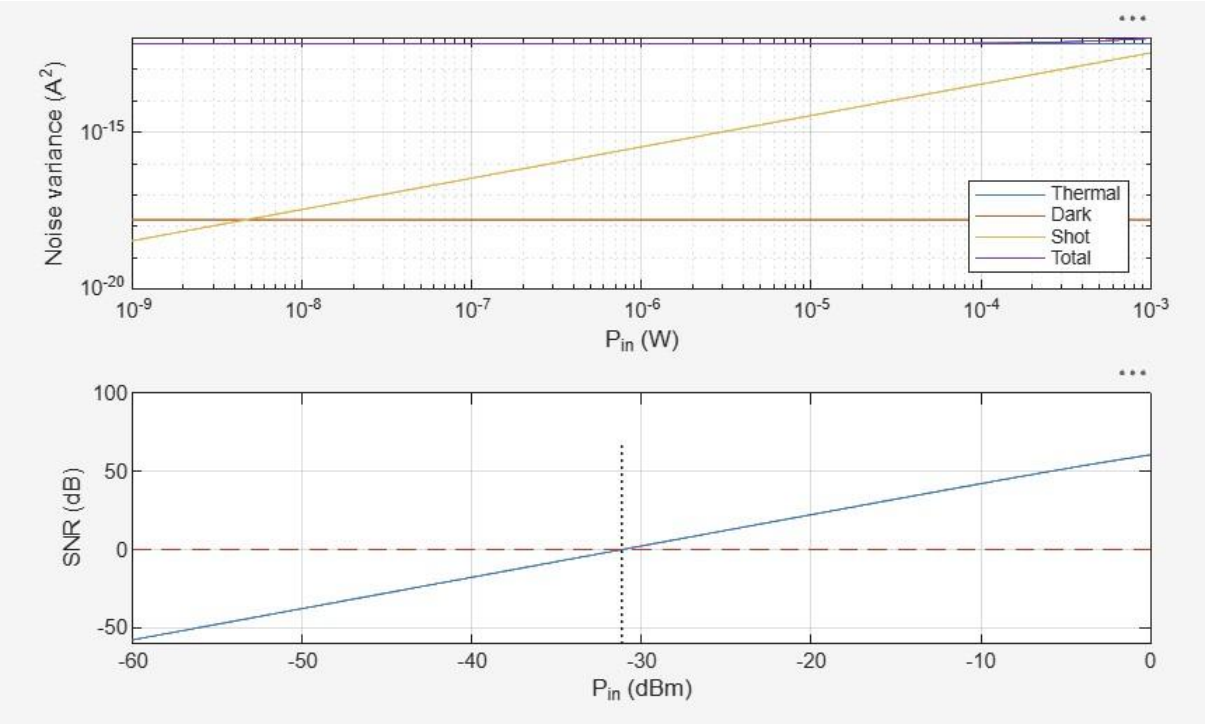
MATLAB

CODE:

```
clc; clear;
close all;
q = 1.602e-19; kB = 1.381e-23; h = 6.626e-34; c = 2.998e8;
lambda = 1550e-9; % wavelength (m) eta
= 0.85; % quantum efficiency
Id = 5e-9; % dark current (A)
T = 300; % temperature (K)
RL = 50; % load resistance (ohm)
Fn = 2; % noise figure (3 dB = 2 linear)
B = 1e9; % bandwidth (Hz)
Pdbm = -60:0.1:0; % input power sweep (dBm)
P = 10.^((Pdbm-30)/10); % input power (W)
%% 2. Responsivity and signal current
R = eta*q*lambda/(h*c);
Ip = R*P;
%% 3. Noise variances and SNR
var_shot = 2*q*Ip*B; var_dark =
2*q*Id*B; var_th =
4*kB*T*B*Fn/RL; var_tot = var_shot
+ var_dark + var_th;
SNR_dB = 10*log10(Ip.^2 ./ var_tot); %% 4.
Minimum detectable power (SNR = 1) a = R^2; b
= -2*q*B*R; cc = -(var_dark + var_th);
Pmin = (-b + sqrt(b^2 - 4*a*cc))/(2*a);
PmindBm = 10*log10(Pmin) + 30;
%% 5. Display results
[~,k] = min(abs(Pdbm+30)); % index of -30 dBm fprintf('Responsivity R
= %.4f A/W\n', R); fprintf('Thermal variance = %.3e A^2\n', var_th);
fprintf('Dark variance = %.3e A^2\n', var_dark); fprintf('Shot variance(-
30) = %.3e A^2\n', var_shot(k)); fprintf('SNR at -30 dBm = %.2f dB\n',
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SNR_dB(k)); fprintf('Pmin (SNR = 1) = %.2f dBm (%.1f nW)\n',
PmindBm, Pmin*1e9);
%% 6. Plots subplot(2,1,1); loglog(P, var_th*ones(size(P)), P, var_dark*ones(size(P)),
P, var_shot, P, var_tot); grid on; xlabel('P_{in} (W)'); ylabel('Noise variance (A^2)');
legend('Thermal','Dark','Shot','Total','Location','best'); subplot(2,1,2); plot(Pdbm,
SNR_dB); hold on; plot([-60 0],[0 0],'r--'); plot([PmindBm PmindBm],[-60
    70],'k:');
grid on; xlabel('P_{in} (dBm)'); ylabel('SNR (dB)');
```

OUTPUT:



REFLECTION:

The experiment helped me understand how shot noise, dark current noise and thermal noise affect photodetector performance. The MATLAB graphs show the relationship between input optical power and SNR.

LABORATORY PERFORMANCE ASSESSMENT RUBRIC

Objective	Assessment Criterion	Excellent – 4	Good – 3	Satisfactory -2	Needs Improvement – 1	Weightage	Marks Obtained
Develop the MATLAB program with correct constants and system parameters.	Program Setup and Parameter Definition	Defines all constants and parameters correctly with proper units and a clean script structure, independently.	Defines parameters correctly with minor unit or syntax errors and limited assistance.	Defines most parameters but needs considerable assistance or has unit errors (e.g., dBm/W, linear Fn).	Unable to set up the script or define the parameters.	25	
Compute R, signal current, noise variances and SNR across the power sweep.	Simulation Execution and Data Acquisition	Computes R, Ip, all noise variances and SNR correctly over −60 to 0 dBm and records the values.	Computes all quantities with minor errors or omissions.	Computes some quantities with noticeable errors or inconsistencies.	Unable to run the simulation or record the values.	25	
Obtain the noise and SNR plots and determine Pmin.	Graph PloBing and Pmin Determination	Plots accurate log–log and semi-log curves with labels and reference lines; Pmin within 5% of the reference.	Plots the curves with minor errors; Pmin identified with small deviation.	Plots partial or poorly scaled curves; Pmin approximate.	Unable to plot the curves or determine Pmin.	25	
Interpret noise regimes, SNR slopes and receiver sensitivity.	Analysis and Engineering Interpretation	Correctly identifies thermal- and shotlimited regimes, explains the SNR slopes and links results to receiver design.	Identifies the regimes with minor errors and reasonable interpretation	Performs basic interpretation with noticeable errors or limited justification.	Unable to interpret the results.	25	

RESULT

The study shows how input optical power affects noise and SNR in a PIN photodetector receiver. Performance depends on the power level. Low power: thermal noise dominates, giving negative SNR and no reliable detection (below Pmin ≈ −31.16 dBm). Moderate power: the signal rises above the thermal noise and the SNR increase at 20 dB/decade. High power: SNR becomes large and shot noise grows linearly, approaching the thermal level near +2.9 dBm. These results help in estimating the receiver sensitivity and in designing low-noise optical receivers.